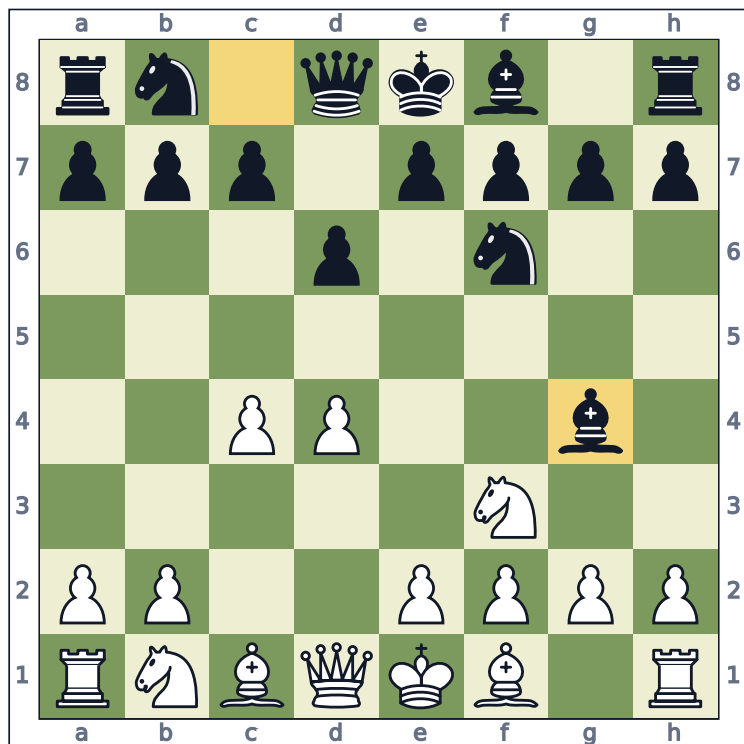


BENONI, BENKO, AND INDIAN STRUCTURES

Old Indian Defense

ECO A54 | 4 named lines in this code



Featured opening position - gold marks the last move

IS IT A GOOD OPENING?

Playable, but White has a meaningful objective edge. Black needs accurate counterplay.

ENGINE SNAPSHOT

+0.69 for White. A shallow opening score is a guide, not a forced result.

GAME CHARACTER

Principled and instructive: development and central breaks lead naturally into the middlegame.

WHAT THIS OPENING IS

A54 covers Old Indian Defense. The center becomes asymmetric: White often owns space, while Black seeks dynamic files, diagonals, and pawn breaks. The diagram uses the featured line Old Indian Defense: Tartakower-Indian.

DEFINING ROUTE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 d6 3. Nf3 Bg4

UNDERSTAND THE POSITION

What both sides are trying to achieve

WHITE'S GOALS

Use the space advantage, finish development, support e4, and prepare a central or queenside expansion without overextending.

BLACK'S GOALS

Attack the pawn center with ...e6, ...c5, or ...b5, activate the dark-squared bishop, and create counterplay before White consolidates.

PAWN BREAKS - THE ENGINE OF THE OPENING

White commonly uses e5 or b4; Black's thematic resources include ...e6, ...b5, and sometimes ...f5.

PIECE MAP

White's central pawns need piece support. Black's bishops and rooks become strong when files open on the queenside. The central pawn placement should decide where each bishop and knight belongs.

WHAT USUALLY GOES WRONG

Space is valuable but can become a target. A premature pawn advance may leave weak squares behind it. Recheck the center after every opponent deviation; opening names do not make moves automatic.

POSITION SNAPSHOT

White moves next. Material is level. Central markers: White pawn on c4, White pawn on d4, Black pawn on d6.

WHO SHOULD STUDY IT?

Good for ambitious players: strategically rich and fully playable, but many lines require comfort with imbalance.

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named A54 line

This section preserves all 4 names and defining routes assigned to A54 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

001 Old Indian Defense: Duz-Khotimirsky Variation

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 d6 3. Nc3 e5 4. e3 Nbd7 5. Bd3

002 Old Indian Defense: Tartakower-Indian

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 d6 3. Nf3 Bg4

003 Old Indian Defense: Two Knights Variation

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 d6 3. Nc3 e5 4. Nf3

004 Old Indian Defense: Ukrainian Variation

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 d6 3. Nc3 e5